A Typical Day for Dad Right Now: A Family Worksheet

One ordinary day, written down from morning to overnight, with who is there for each part.

“He's managing okay” covers a lot of ground. One ordinary day, written down from breakfast to bedtime, gives the next person who asks something to work with.

Pick a recent, ordinary day and write it the way it went, not the way it's supposed to go or the way someone has suggested it should change. Put a time and a name wherever you can. For any part of the day nobody in the family has seen, write “don't know” and leave it.

Where Dad is right now, and who helps

Where he is living or staying this week, who else is there, and who comes by.

FOR EXAMPLE At home, in the house, on his own. My sister comes most mornings, I come after work, and the neighbor across the street looks in around lunchtime.

Morning

From getting up to about noon. What happens, in order, and who is there for it.

FOR EXAMPLE Up around 7. My sister stops in at 8 on her way to work, makes the coffee and sets out his pills. He has breakfast on his own after she leaves, I think. I haven't asked him.

Daytime

Noon to late afternoon. Meals, visitors, appointments, and the hours he spends on his own.

FOR EXAMPLE On his own from about 9 until 12:30. The neighbor brings the mail in at lunchtime and stays a few minutes. On Tuesdays my brother drives him to his appointment.

Evening

Supper through bedtime. Who is there, who phones, and how the day winds down.

FOR EXAMPLE I come by at 5:30, we have supper, and I leave about 7:30. My brother calls him at 8 most nights. Bed around 10, as far as I know.

Overnight

Who is in the house at night, and who Dad would phone. If nobody knows how the nights go, say that.

FOR EXAMPLE Nobody stays over. His phone is by the bed and my number is the first one in it. None of us has been there overnight, so we don't know how the nights go.

What is different from a month ago, and when it changed

Only changes in how the day runs, with the date if you have it. If you note something that has been suggested but hasn't happened, write “proposed” beside it and who suggested it.

FOR EXAMPLE Until Thursday he drove himself to the diner for breakfast. Since then my sister has been coming by in the mornings. Proposed, by my brother: someone staying over for a while.

Before you put it away

- At the top of the page, write which day you described, the date, and who wrote it.
- Ask someone who sees a different part of Dad's week to fill in their own. If the two pages don't match, keep both.
- Show it to Dad if you can, and add what he'd put differently, in his words.

What this shows you

Three things: how Dad's day runs now, who is there for each part of it, and which parts nobody in the family can describe. It doesn't show whether the arrangement is enough or what should change. Nothing here adds up to a score or a level, and questions about Dad's health go to the people who treat him.

Ready for the next step?

You've written down one ordinary day, with the times, the names and the parts nobody has seen. The care interview starts from a day like that and keeps going, through Dad's living arrangement and each area of daily life in order, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

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